

Cosmic Shore

Re-run on 21 September against `bleeding-edge` , nine days after Revision 4. **The six-week window the plan was written against closed on 11 September.** Engineering kept arriving; verification did not start; and this run corrects three claims Revision 4 got wrong — one of them materially in the project's favour.

AUDITED

21 Sep 2026

PREVIOUS

Rev 4 · 12 Sep

BRANCH

bleeding-edge 0eef7c5b

PLAN OF RECORD

Rev 2 · 31 Jul — window elapsed

NOT COVERED

Off-machine work; editor runtime

DAYS PAST THE PLAN'S OWN WINDOW 10 Six weeks from 31 July ended 11 September. No week-one gate has been cleared.	NEW GAME MODES SINCE "0 LEFT TO BUILD" 19 Measured by mode id against 31 July. 1,966 commits in the same window.	QA VERDICTS 1 Unchanged since 14 August — now 38 days old, against 25 live modes.	PROGRESSION SYSTEM Absent Third consecutive audit. All four sub-claims re-verified independently.
DEFINITION OF DONE 2/8 Unchanged from Revision 4. The four that cannot pass are the same four.			

Revision 2 was written on 31 July with a six-week calendar path. That path ended on **11 September**. Every prior audit measured the project against the plan's *content*; this one starts by measuring it against the plan's *clock*, because that is the number an investor reads first and no checkpoint has stated it.

Week one of that plan required a Steamworks partner account, the Direct fee paid, and an app record created. `Tools/Steam/upload.sh` still opens with the line *"NOTHING HERE RUNS UNTIL THE APP EXISTS ON STEAMWORKS"*, and both `STEAM_APPID` and `STEAM_DEPOTID` remain unset required variables. On the repository's own evidence, **week one has not happened**. Weeks two through six each depend on it.

THE PREMISE THAT EXPIRED FIRST

Revision 2's headline was **"0 features left to build"** and *"feature-complete"*. That was true when written. Measured from the commit at 31 July to `0eef7c5b` : **1,966 commits** (1,535 non-merge), **19 new game-mode ids**, and enabled scenes in build settings **15 → 33**.

The new modes are Cleave, Wildlife Liberation, Dog Fight, The Bends, Scarab Scramble, Salvo, Switchback, Hijack, Tollway, Headlong, Breakwater, Skein, Bloomrush, Redline, Wrecking Ball, Undertow, Regatta, Broadside and Online Duel for the Cell. This is not a criticism of the work — it is uniformly high quality. It is that **the thing being shipped is no longer the thing that was scoped**, and every validation estimate in the plan was sized against the smaller game.

02 THREE CORRECTIONS TO REVISION 4

An audit is only worth its own accuracy. Three of Revision 4's statements do not survive re-measurement, and the first one moves the project's risk position in the right direction.

REV 4 SAID	VERDICT	WHAT THE TREE SHOWS
"Nothing in CI builds a Windows player."	WRONG	<code>.github/workflows/unity-ci.yml</code> runs a weekly IL2CPP Windows player build on a self-hosted runner via <code>CosmicShoreBuildPipeline.BuildWindowsRelease</code> , and a <i>Verify</i>

REV 4 SAID	VERDICT	WHAT THE TREE SHOWS
		<i>build output</i> step fails the job unless <code>CosmicShore.exe</code> exists. The scheduled run of 17 September was green , as were 7 of the last 10. The step existed at Revision 4's own base commit. A Windows player is being built; nobody has launched one. R1's substance holds — its stated evidence does not.
R14 "Not started" — licence register and launch-blocker index.	STALE	It landed the <i>same day</i> as the audit (PRs #871 and #873, merged 12 Sep from a branch since deleted). <code>bleeding-edge</code> carries the  . More importantly the one verified compliance gap — FMOD EULA clause 3 requiring an in-game "FMOD / Firelight Technologies Pty Ltd." credit on every tier — is closed and gated : <code>Assets/Resources/CreditsManifest.asset</code> , a release build guard, and <code>check_credits_manifest.py --check</code> , which passes.
"54 red + 3 amber = 57 open items" in the verification checklist.	DISPUTED	Counting section markers gives 45 red + 1 amber + 1 green = 46 open , and the checklist's <i>own banner</i> states 46. The two counts use different units; 57 is not reproducible. The conclusion is unaffected — none of them has been absorbed into QA — but the figure should not be quoted.

03 WHAT MOVED IN NINE DAYS

MEASURE	REV 4 · 12 SEP	NOW · 21 SEP	READING
Live arcade modes	21	25	Arcade 21 + Arena 4 (Regatta, Broadside new)
<code>GameModes</code> members	51	55	
Scenes in build settings	29	33	2 further entries disabled (tool scenes)
Vessel slots named	26/32	29/32	Rhino +1, Serpent +2
Level-5 upgrades authored	22/32	23/32	Net +1, including one regression — see below
QA backlog items	64	68	62 never run
QA backlog scan date	13 Aug	13 Aug	Now 39 days stale
QA verdicts on record	1	1	Unchanged since 14 Aug

Progression service	absent	absent	All four sub-claims re-verified
Friend-request callers	0	0	The growth model's own mechanism

A LEVEL-5 UPGRADE WAS REMOVED, NOT ADDED

The net +1 hides a subtraction. `ElementalAbilityMaps/Scarab.asset` line 53 now carries an empty `UpgradeLabel` where it read *Armored Switch* at Revision 4 — cleared deliberately when the switch's prism fill was retired. Its `AbilityLabel` still reads "Switch", so the slot counts as **named** while its upgrade no longer exists. Open design slots are now Rhino elements 1 and 3, and Serpent element 2.

04 THE BLOCKING FINDING, THIRD AUDIT RUNNING

The quest and progression system is still not part of the build. Each sub-claim was re-measured from scratch rather than carried forward, and each one holds.

The service <code>GameModeProgressionService</code> is reached only through <code>.Instance</code> by 17 consumers. There is no <code>new</code>, no <code>AddComponent</code>, no <code>Resources.Load</code>.	Its only host Script guid <code>541692fb...</code> appears in exactly one asset: <code>_Prefabs/Migration_Prefabs (DELETE LATER)/PlayerDataService.prefab</code>.	That prefab Its own guid has zero references across <code>Assets/</code>, <code>ProjectSettings/</code> and <code>Packages/</code>.
The consequence <code>ArcadeExploreView.cs:252</code> reads <code>progressionService != null && !IsGameModeUnlocked(...)</code> — a null service fails open, so every one of the 25 modes renders unlocked.		

This remains correct and expected while design works the chain. It is restated because **four more modes shipped into an arcade that no progression gates**, and because Definition of Done #4 is unreachable however much dialogue is authored.

05 NEW THIS RUN: WHAT AN OUTSIDER WOULD SEE FIRST

The invite build is the first thing anyone outside the studio will touch. Three defects sit on that surface, and none appeared in any tracker.

FINDING	STATE	DETAIL
Seven shipped strings the font cannot draw	FIXED + GATED	The UI font carries 97 glyphs with an empty fallback table , so a character outside it renders as an empty box with nothing logged. Five of the seven were on the connecting / arena-build screen — the screen every player sees on every match. Fixed this pass; <code>Tools/Build/check_tmp_glyph_coverage.py</code> now reads coverage off the font asset and fails CI, with 12 self-test controls.
A shipped card points at a scene that is not in the build	OPEN	<code>ArcadeGameCoOpWildlifeBlitz</code> names <code>MinigameWildlifeBlitzMultiplayerCoOp</code> , which exists on disk but is not in build settings . Launching it from a player build fails. Separately, 20 of 51 arcade cards name scenes that do not exist at all — all legacy single-player, none on a live roster.
The STORE screen is unreachable	OPEN	<code>StoreScreen.cs</code> is a real 234-line implementation with no entry in <code>ScreenSwitcher</code> 's screens list, so the commerce de-scope branch that would mark it is dead code. Not broken — <i>absent</i> . Related: the Arena button is authored Available in <code>Menu_Main.unity</code> while the code comment describes Arena as behind a lock.

AND A THEME SYSTEM NOTHING READS

UI redesign task T4 is marked **DONE**. `UIThemeS0` exists; five of its ten colour tokens and *every* spacing, geometry and motion token have zero C# call sites, and the only reference is one unused `[SerializeField]`. The tracker's own text concedes a code-only task cannot close it. Tasks T2, T5, T6, T7 and T8 remain open, and T5/T6 have been invalidated by a later style decision rather than completed.

06 WHAT ACTUALLY STOPS A STEAM RELEASE

Ordered by what blocks the most behind it. Nothing on this list is blocked on building a feature.

#	BLOCKER	OWNER	WHY IT BLOCKS
1	No Steamworks app exists	HUMAN	H1/H2. The upload script refuses to run without it. Carries external identity, tax and banking lead time, so it cannot be compressed later. Gates DoD #1 and #2 and all of workstreams A and E.
2	No validation has ever run	HUMAN	R1/R2/R3. One QA verdict in the project's history, 38 days old. Backlog 39 days stale at 68 items, 62 never run. 46 checklist items never absorbed. A Windows player builds weekly and has never been launched . Gates DoD #3.
3	Progression service not instantiated	DESIGN	One wiring decision. DoD #4 cannot pass until it is taken, and no amount of quest dialogue changes that.
4	No load-time target	SESSION	R7. The target <i>is</i> the deliverable and does not exist. The matrix is now $25 \times 4 = 100$ combinations, up from the ~28 the original estimate assumed. Gates DoD #5.
5	Licence and entitlement tail	HUMAN	FMOD credit is closed and gated. Still open: the FMOD <i>tier</i> decision against the \$600k/\$200k thresholds; the SOAP receipt (128 first-party files, not removable); the Wwise evaluation-licence question (per-title, survives deleting the folder); "Effects Library" provenance; and vendoring the DOTween and NativeShare notices.
6	Playtest dual-appID pipeline	SESSION	R6. <code>upload.sh</code> still renders exactly one app/depot pair. A Playtest child app is a second target, and the wave runbook does not exist.
7	Six multiplayer fixes, unplaytested	HUMAN	B18–B23 plus Presence B1/B4/B6 are all 🟡 — fixed, never run. Among them: a client could not leave a match, and a lost scene transition was a permanent black screen. These came from <i>playing</i> , not from a tracker.
8	Art and store copy	HUMAN	H13–H15. Capsules in five sizes, trailer, screenshots. 13 person-days on one contributor, and the store page cannot go live without the capsule set.

No criterion changed in nine days. One improved in its evidence without changing state.

1	Steam page live with Playtest signup. The app record does not exist; R6 has no runbook.	BLOCKED
2	Playtest build approved, waves granted, invites on. A player builds weekly and green — but nobody has launched one, and there is nowhere to upload it.	BLOCKED
3	Fresh install → four-player Tournament, zero P0/P1. Unproven. B18–B23 show the defect class is real and only visible from play.	UNPROVEN
4	Quest chain completes, unlocks persist. Service still not instantiated.	CANNOT PASS
5	Load time meets target in every mode. No target published; the matrix grew to 100 cells.	NO TARGET
6	Telemetry cohorted by wave. Client half met — <code>invite_wave</code> on the person record, envelope clean. Dashboards still to build.	CLIENT MET
7	Zero public review surface. Structural.	MET
8	Gate published, exit checklist signed. Measurable since R9; publishing and signing are still H12.	HALF

The verdict has not changed in five weeks, and that is itself the finding. **Nothing on this milestone is blocked on building something** — it is blocked on one account registration, one wiring decision, and a validation pass scoped in July that has still not begun. What has changed is the denominator: the validation pass now faces **25 modes and 100 load-time cells** instead of the game the plan was written against. The engineering continues to arrive well ahead of plan; the evidence that any of it works does not exist.

Every session-lane item that can be closed has been closed, and closing more of them does not move a single Definition-of-Done criterion. The next unit of work with any leverage is **one person, one afternoon, one Windows build launched on one machine** — it unblocks R2 and R3, converts 46 checklist rows and 68 backlog items from "never run" into data, and is the only way the B18–B23 class of defect is ever found. It has been the top of the board since Revision 3.